

Harshatha Prasanna

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SUMMARY

Undergraduate Data Science major at UC San Diego with hands-on experience in Python, R, and statistical analysis, passionate about turning complex data into clear, actionable insights. Independent researcher and strong communicator with a proven ability to make data meaningful for any audience.

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO, San Diego, California

Bachelor of Science in Data Science; Minor in Cognitive Science

May 2028

- GPA: 3.83
- Relevant Coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Statistical Analysis, Research Methods, Programming for Data Science, Practice of Data Science

SKILLS

- Programming: Python, R, Java, SQL, SQLite, Excel
- Data Analysis: Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA), Statistical Modeling, Data Visualization, Hypothesis Testing, A/B Testing
- Machine Learning: Supervised & Unsupervised Learning, Feature Engineering, Model Training & Evaluation
- Libraries & Frameworks: Scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Pytorch, Keras
- Data Tools: Jupyter Notebook, Git, Tableau

PROJECTS & EXPERIENCE

THE STARTUP INCUBATOR CLUB, San Diego, California

March 2026 – Present

Growth Data Analyst

- Built and managed data collection infrastructure for startup recruitment, including a website for attendance tracking and automated email newsletter scripts using curated contact datasets.
- Automated personalized sponsorship email outreach by generating and processing CSV datasets with keyword-based targeting, reducing manual effort and improving campaign efficiency.

RESPONSIBLE DATA MANAGEMENT RESEARCH, San Diego, California

November 2025 – January 2026

Independent Project

- Analyzed American Community Survey data (1.6M observations); identified 29% income gap persisting within identical occupation codes (female managers: \$60K vs. male: \$85K).
- Revealed data infrastructure limitation: datasets document inequality but lack mechanism variables (caregiving, career interruptions) needed to design policy interventions.
- Developed reproducible Python pipeline (pandas, fairlearn, seaborn) with statistical analysis and visualizations; published on GitHub.

UC SAN DIEGO DATA SCIENCE SOCIETY (DS3), San Diego, California

January 2025 – May 2025

Data Analyst

- Analyzed the CDC's NHANES dataset (12,000+ participants, 34 clinical and lifestyle features) to uncover key risk factors for diabetes and deliver actionable insights.
- Optimized hyperparameters and applied Repeated Stratified K-Fold cross-validation; selected XGBoost for its top performance, achieving 96% cross-validated accuracy.
- Enhanced diabetic case identification, delivering a **26% increase in recall**, and **61% increase in precision** compared to the baseline model.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certifications: Explainable AI (XAI) — **Duke University** (2026), Introduction to Deep Learning and Neural Networks with Keras — **IBM** (2026), Machine Learning with Python — **IBM** (2025), SQL for Data Science — **University of California, Davis** (2025)